Curatorial Rationale

As a highly introspective person, my artworks mostly stem from personal experiences and beliefs. My effort during my art journey was to create artworks that explore my diverse personality and lead my viewers into questioning who they really are.

12 years of my school life made me the optimistic person I am. The view represents my school motto, “Ever Forward”, the ocean being a symbol of the ups and downs of life. Inspired by the realistic Indian artist Shuchi Krishan, I focused on the architecture from my school to depict my origin.

Trying to gain a better understanding of who I am, I asked people around me to share their perceptions of who they thought I was. I then assembled my 3D artwork, ‘Vani’s house’ to show that even though my internal structure remains constant, each room represents an individual aspect of me.

Resonating with the character Waldo in “Where’s Waldo?”, I don’t know where I may study - the United States, Singapore and India. In this landscape, I’ve hidden smaller Vanis in each location - identifiable with sunglasses and a running figure, as I’m always in a hurry to get somewhere.

While people often spend time looking for Waldo, I realised that something I can never seem to find is time. Using a stop motion animation, I showed my relationship with time based on my interests, physics, music, and business investments. This encouraged me to express my theories through art.

I painted my response to the attitude towards meat consumption in my environment, inspired by the surrealistic works by artists Thukral and Tagra. The imagery in this painting is inspired by Carol Ann Duffy’s poem, A Healthy Meal. This piece emphasises the contrasts between the dreams of voiceless cows and the ease with which meat is consumed today.

Intrigued by the formations and swift forceful movements of a flush, I tried to convey its various functions through black and white patterned illustrations which contrast colourful splashes to represent the uncontrollable flow of life that overlaps structure and detail.

In my final artwork, I wanted to deliver viewers the different symbolic meanings flowers hold across cultures by viewing themselves amid them.

Like the song ‘Man in the Mirror’ by Micheal Jackson, I believe that all change starts from within and expressing my ideas through impactful art is how I’d like to initiate change.